

HEMALURGY RULES

A Fan-made Ruleset for Cosmere® RPG



by Pether.pg

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Hemalurgy Rules



1.1 Hemalurgy Skill

To obtain Hemalurgy skill, a PC must take a Key talent from the Hemalurgy talent tree and complete the goal related to it. At this point, they are free to attempt to steal attributes and powers from their enemies.

See 1.2. "Hemalurgy Talents" for more details.

Hemalurgy (Intellect)

Activation: ►

After you pierce your target with a metal spike, you may spend 1 Focus as ► to make a Hemalurgy test against Spiritual Defence of the target. On a success, the spike is placed in a correct binding point, allowing to steal one of the target's characteristic (like an attribute or skill ranks) and collect a Hemalurgic Spike after the target dies.

A Hemalurgic Spike created this way has Blessing [Characteristic +Potency] and Whispers of Ruin [+Hemalurgy ranks], where Characteristic is a chosen by the hemalurgist at the time of the test roll and Potency is determined by users ranks in Hemalurgy and the target's statistics.

Hemalurgic Spike

Hemalurgic Spike is an item created as a result of a successful Hemalurgy test. It retains all stats of a spike used to create it and adds the additional traits on top of them:

Blessing

A character pierced by this item receives bonus to a characteristic, as specified in brackets. (eg. *Blessing [Strength +2] grants +2 to the Strength attribute*)

Whispers of Ruin

A character pierced by this item can be influenced by Ruin. A DC of resisting the influence is a sum of numbers specified in brackets of various Hemalurgic Spikes in use.

Whispers of Ruin

Each Hemalurgic Spike has **Whispers of Ruin [+X]** trait. If a character using the spike rolls ✨, the GM might spend it to request a Discipline test from that character. The DC of the test equals the sum of **Whispers of Ruin** traits' values on the spikes used by the PC.

On a failure, Ruin takes control over the character, forcing them to take hostile, murderous and/or destructive actions. It is up to the GM if the character becomes an NPC for the rest of the game, forcing their player to create a new PC.

Piercing the Target

Unless the target is a willing character, is Unconscious or Restrained, you must make a test against the targets Physical Defense to determine if you successfully pierce them with a spike. Depending on the context, the GM might request a Thievery or other skill for that purpose, and the attempt costs at least ►.

Initially, to pierce their target, a Hemalurgist requires focus and precision, making it impossible to use in the chaos of combat. Some talents may modify this, expanding it to eg. attacks with a melee weapon.

Capacity

The bigger the spike, the more power it can absorb with Hemalurgy. If the characteristic you are trying to steal with a spike has a numeric value (like an attribute or skill ranks), the spike can hold only an amount of it equal to the half of the size of its damage die, rounded up. (eg. a spike dealing 1d6 damage can hold up to 3 skill ranks of the stolen skill.)

$$\text{spike's capacity} = \frac{\text{max}(\text{spike's damage die})}{2}$$

Potency

Once the Hemalurgic Spike is created as a result of a character's Hemalurgy test, it steals some amount of the selected characteristic. If a numeric value can be assigned to it, it steals whatever the target had before the test, but never more than the number of ranks of the Hemalurgy skill the user has.

Please note, that the spike can never hold more power than it's capacity. To steal more power, you will need bigger spikes.

$$\text{stolen value} = \min(\text{target's value, Hemalurgy rank, spike's capacity})$$

Hemalurgy on Higher Tiers

The art of Hemalurgy requires a lot of practice and study. Novice Hemalurgy users will not be able to correctly use all types of spikes, but they will learn to do so with time. Because of that, using Hemalurgy skill with some metals requires higher tiers, as follows:

Characters on tier 1:

You can use Physical metals: iron, steel, tin and pewter.

Characters on tier 2:

You can use Cognitive metals: zinc, brass, copper and bronze.

Characters on tier 3:

You can use Temporal metals: cadmium, bendalloy, gold and electrum.

Characters on tier 4:

You can use Spiritual metals: chromium, nicrosil, aluminum and duralumin.

Characters on any tier:

You can use God metals: atium, lerasium, harmonium, etc., though some of them may work differently depending on your tier.

Metal Spike

Depending on a metal used to make the spike, different characteristics of the target may be stolen with Hemalurgy. If the spike is made of metal allowing to steal multiple characteristics, one of them must be selected at the time of making the Hemalurgy test.

The following metals allow to steal the characteristics listed below:

- Iron: steals Strength or Speed
- Steel: steals one physical Allomantic power (Iron, Pewter, Steel, or Tin Allomancy)
- Tin: steals Awareness or Presence
- Pewter: steals one physical Feruchemical power (Iron, Pewter, Steel, or Tin Feruchemy)
- Zinc: steals Willpower
- Brass: steals one cognitive Feruchemical power (Brass, Bronze, Copper, or Zinc Feruchemy)
- Copper: steals Intellect
- Bronze: steals one mental Allomantic power (Brass, Bronze, Copper, or Zinc Allomancy)
- Cadmium: steals one temporal Allomantic power (Bendalloy, Cadmium, Electrum, or Gold Allomancy)
- Bendalloy: steals one spiritual Feruchemical power (Aluminum, Chromium, Duralumin, or Nicrosil Feruchemy)
- Gold: steals one hybrid Feruchemical power (Bendalloy, Cadmium, Electrum, or Gold Feruchemy)
- Electrum: steals one enhancement Allomantic power (Aluminum, Chromium, Duralumin, or Nicrosil Allomancy)
- Chromium: might steal Destiny (*interpretation up to the GM*)
- Nicrosil: steals maximum Investiture
- Aluminum: removes all Invested powers upon piercing, but does not steal them for the Hemalurgist
- Duralumin: steals Connection or Identity
- Atium: steals any power or attribute you could steal at your current tier.
- Lerasium: steals all powers or attributes you could steal at your current tier.

1.2 Hemalurgy Talents

Protégé of Ruin (Key Talent)

Prerequisite: Hemalurgist Patron or other source of knowledge about the art of Hemalurgy.

Activation: ★

The art that is unique to Hemalurgy is the knowledge of where to place the spikes.

Gain Hemalurgy Expertise, which allows you to recognize Hemalurgic Spikes and to know their application. Additionally, you gain the goal "Learn Hemalurgy". After you complete it, you gain Hemalurgy skill and 1 rank in it.

Combat Hemalurgy

Prerequisite: Complete "Learn Hemalurgy" goal.

Activation: ∞

Kill her with the spike, and drive it into your own body. That is the only way!

You may use Hemalurgy after you hit another character with a metal melee weapon you have an expertise in, as long as you spend ☉ from that attack. In that case, your metal weapon will take the role of the spike.

Starting from tier 2, you may also use this talent after hitting a character with a ranged weapon you have an expertise in. Starting from tier 3, you may also use this talent after a trap you made triggered and hit a character.

Ruinous Spike

Prerequisite: Stacking Potency talent

Activation: ∞

YOU SHOULD KILL THEM.

After you successfully pass the Hemalurgy test, the target suffers 2d4 spirit damage. The size of dice increases with your ranks in Hemalurgy; at 2 ranks, roll 2d6 (instead of 2d4), and so on.

Steel Linchpin

Prerequisite: Lore 4+; Ruinous Spike talent

Activation: ∞

Another spike! That is the secret!

You may use steel spikes to steal the target's capacity for the number of Hemalurgic Spikes a person can use at the same time before succumbing to Ruin's influence.

As described in "Hemalurgic Spike Effects - Spiritweb Disruption" (*Mistborn Handbook*, page 291.), a person can usually use 3 Hemalurgic Spikes before the Shard takes control of them. You may use the Linchpin Spike to increase that limit.

The Linchpin counts as a Spike toward that limit. A person can have only one Linchpin. If at any point you lose the Linchpin while having 4 or more other Spikes, your character is lost to Ruin.

Stacking Potency

Prerequisite: Complete "Learn Hemalurgy" goal.

Activation: ∞

Roughly five percent Invested. Fully Investing one spike takes between twenty and thirty people.

You may use a previously created Hemalurgic Spike as a spike while testing Hemalurgy to increase its potency. If you do, you may only choose to steal the same characteristic as was previously stolen by the spike.

The new potency is 1 higher than the previous one, or 1 higher than whatever the spike would have after the new Hemalurgy test, whichever is higher. At any point the potency of a newly created Hemalurgic Spike cannot exceed a number of your ranks in Hemalurgy or the spike's capacity.

If the Spike had previously had a smaller Whispers of Ruin value than your current Hemalurgy ranks, update the value to the higher value.

You cannot use this talent if either the target or your Spike don't have at least 1 of the characteristic you wish to steal (eg. if you have some trace amounts stolen with Vestigial Powers).

Deathless Spike

Prerequisite: Medicine 3+; Stacking Potency talent

Activation: ∞

The process involves a very thin spike, my lord, and, oddly, the right mindset.

You don't need to wait for the donor's death to collect the Hemalurgic Spike after the successful Hemalurgy test. Once the Spike is removed from the donor's body, they lose the characteristic stolen by the Spike in the amount of the Spike's potency.

Vestigial Powers

Prerequisite: Lore 4+; Stacking Potency talent

Activation: ∞

They don't need that extra if the powers didn't manifest in them. We simply slice it off and use it in a spike.

You may choose to steal a skill your target does not have developed (eg. a specific Allomantic power). If you do, after collecting the created Spike, roll 1d20 and divide the result by 100 to determine the amount your Spike has stolen.

When determining the total bonus granted by the Spike, round down the Spike's Blessing value. The Blessing must be at least 1 to give you any noticeable effects.

While the amount gathered from a single donor will not be enough to grant you the skill, you may repeat the process on more targets, each time adding the new result to the existing total. Each character can be targeted like that only once.

Hemlurgy Talent Tree

Bring death and ruin on your foes, steal their powers to use as your own.



★ Protégé of Ruin (Key)

Prerequisite: Patron or other source of Hemalurgic knowledge.

Gain Hemalurgy Expertise and start "Learn Hemalurgy" goal. After you complete it, you will gain Hemalurgy skill.

HEMALURGY

∞ Combat Hemalurgy

Prerequisite: Complete "Learn Hemalurgy"

You may spend  to use Hemalurgy after hitting with a weapon.

∞ Ruinous Spike

Successful Hemalurgy deals 2d4 spirit damage (more with additional Hemalurgy ranks).

∞ Steel Linchpin

Prerequisite: Lore 4+

You may steal a capacity to use more Hemalurgic Spikes.

∞ Stacking Potency

Prerequisite: Complete "Learn Hemalurgy"

You may use the same spike multiple times to increase its potency.

∞ Deathless Spike

Prerequisite: Medicine 3+

Your target doesn't need to die in order to create a Hemalurgic Spike.

∞ Vestigial Powers

Prerequisite: Lore 4+

You may steal a trace amounts of a skill your target has not developed.

1.3 Hemalurgist's Weaponry

While any metal weapon can be used to create a Hemalurgic Spike, a Hemalurgist may prefer to select tools designed for this purpose.

1.3.1 Weapon Traits

Some of the weapons presented in this chapter have new traits. You can find their definitions listed below:

Brutal

Attacks made with this weapon gain an advantage to their damage dice.

Precise

Attacks made with this weapon gain an advantage to determine if the attack hits the target.

Quiet

Attacks made with this weapon do not alert the enemies about your position.

Restraining

Spend  from the attack with this weapon to make the target you hit Restrained.

Subtle

While attacking with this weapon you may choose not to add your skill bonus to the damage dealt.

1.3.2 Weapons

Skill	Type	Damage	Range	Traits	Expert Traits
Light Weaponry	Needle	0-1 keen	Melee	Discreet, Unique: Subtle	Unique: Precise
Light Weaponry	Small Spike	1d4 keen	Melee	Quickdraw	Offhand
Light Weaponry	Needle Blower	0-1 keen	Ranged [30/120]	Quickdraw	Unique: Quiet
Heavy Weaponry	Big Spike	1d6 keen	Melee	Pierce	Offhand
Heavy Weaponry	Hammer and Nail	1d8 keen	Melee	Two-Handed, Deadly	Unique: Brutal
Heavy Weaponry	Spike Thrower	1d6 keen	Ranged [150/600]	Loaded[1], Two-Handed	Unique: Restraining